

Sufi Songs of Assam: Zikir and Zari

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Abstract

Zikir and Zari represent a style of province; they appear to be a gaggle of pious songs current among the Muslims of Assam. The Zikir and Zari unit of measurement similar in tune, Zikir songs embody the teaching of Islam whereas the Zari songs unit of measurement supported the tragic episodes of the city tragedy. Zikir The term Zikir, derived from Arabic “Ziqr”, literary suggests that singing or memory Allah’s name. It applies every to the style and to the occasion of its performance, the pious assembly of theism mysticism or mysticism in province. Zikir, took root in province throughout the seventeenth century among the socio-cultural framework instituted by devotion movement of Saint Srimanta Sankardev (1449-1568) and below the patronage of Ahom (1200-1800 kings).

Keywords: Azan Fakir, Assam, Sufi, Zikir, Zari.

Introduction

Zikirs were primarily composed and popularized by the seventeenth century Sufi saint and author Hazrat Shah Miran, popularly named as Ajan Fakir. Ajan Fakir came to province from capital of Iraq amid his brother Shah Navi, and settled in Shawraguri Sapor, on the bank of great Sibsagar town. To keep with a legend, Hazrat Shah Miran received the name “Ajan Fakir” or Ajan Pir (Saint) as a result of he was the one United Nations agency schooled the Assamese Muslim to recite “Azan” as it’s a region of Muslim ritual. The time of Ajan Fakir can’t be declared completely but from references in a pair of provinces chronicles and plenty of Zikirs prove his confine Assam in seventeenth century. Among the next Zikir, Ajan Fakir diagrammatic the time he composed Zikir and therefore the al-Qur'an the provision of the Zikir radiotelegraphic signal “Dos sao dukuri nabison hijiri aru pase bosor jai Ajan Fakire ai zikir korile Kuran kitapot pai.” Ajan Fakir composed the Zikir in 1038 Hijri (1636). The al-Qur'an is that the provision of this Zikir. It’s acknowledged from history that Muslim settlers stepped in to province as Mughal and Pathans invaders. The Badshah and therefore the Sultans of metropolis created many tries of expedition to beat province and as a result alittle sort of Muslims stayed back as prisoners of war. Apart from these invasions, throughout the Ahom reign some Muslim artists of special skills were foreign from varied a region of land. A substantial sort of these Muslim settler married native Assamese women and collectively adopted Assamese culture. Though the underlying motivation of Ajan Fakir was the preaching of Islam, he was very influenced by the Vaisnavite thoughts, teaching and music of Sankardeva. Singing the glory of Allah and Islam in high lyrical terms typically decreased partially to explaining the ideas and issues in terms of events and activities of fashion of the folks. It’s collectively attention-grabbing to notice the Zikirs unit of measurement able to build a bridge in guaranteeing the harmonious relationship between Islam and Hinduism, considerably with Vaisnavism. one in each of the foremost spectacular example of Bha doctrines preached by

Ajan Fakir to specific admiration for this sect of Hinduism as follows. Sankardeur jiyari Madhavdeur buwari Rahpur nagarat ghar Rahpur nagarat rasak nami cuckoo Diya sakaloke bati She is that the feminine offspring of Sankardeva and relation of Madhavadev; and he or she or he or he wells among city of Rahpur or land of rasa aesthetics); that's, the sentiment of tenderness and devotion; bring down the rasa from town of Rahpur and distribute in among North yank country all. Ajan Fakir had encountered extensive issue in helpful Islam as current in province throughout the seventeenth century; it had already deviated here from its main principles and practices. It's declared that in that quantity the native Muslims accustomed participate among the singing of Kirtana-songs for community prayer composed by Sankardeva, for the aim of propagating Vaisnavism. The Muslim collectively took mahprasads (uncooked eatables generally consisting of gram, sugarcane, coconut, ginger and fruits) distributed at the very best of the community singing of Kirtana. With a vi attracting these Muslims towards Islam, Ajan Fakir introduced the custom of distribution of sinni (considered food prepared out of rice) at the very best of the community singing of Zikir and Zar song apart from Vaishnavite music, Ajan Fakir was collectively greatly galvanized by the regional music of province similar to the tone and spirit of various Assamese people genre like Oja-pali and Deh bicarar geet. Ajan religious person adopted the apple of Vaisnavite lyrics; one typically comes across lines "Savaro ghate ghate Alla" patently borrowed from Vaisnavite poetry.

Conclusion

Ajan religious person himself was associate honest singer and poet; he composed 100 and sixty Zikirs in Assamese. tho' Islam doesn't promote music and dance for diversion, from the spiritual perspective there's no restriction in and of itself. At that point dance and music planted a really common suggests that of praying to God among the Hindu and therefore the Muslim communities of province. Ajan Fakir and his disciples, popularly named as "Bhakat" in Assamese, performed Zikir, terpsichore and singing with commendation like people performance like Diha nam, Husori, etc. Even today Zikir songs unit of measurement performed with dance in some areas of province.

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